

Benue Breast Cancer Support Initiative (BBCSI)

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A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER



I am honored to be associated with this grassroot network of breast cancer survivors, other nonprofits, event sponsors and committed donors working together to bring cancer awareness to the women of Benue State. As a network of stakeholders, we collaborated in 2023 to make intentional strides towards our goal to dispel the culture of secrecy. In the ordinary course of our work, we lost some of our survivors in the fight against breast cancer. Their memories remind us that there is even more work to be done.

Our primary mission is to dismantle the culture of secrecy that surrounds breast cancer among women of color. As this report shows, we are committed to our advocacy work of creating awareness of breast cancer by encouraging women to do breast exams and giving breast cancer survivors a means to pursue small cottage businesses via our micro loan program.

In 2022, we disbursed our first long-term loan for a member who approached us for assistance in the form of a loan for breast cancer surgery. We look forward to one day have the capacity to give grants to our members for breast cancer related treatment as well as subsidize their breast cancer medications.

In 2023, we expanded our long-term loan program by assisting two members of our volunteer Executive Committee who had pressing family emergencies. It is our hope that by operating the micro and macro loan programs, we will provide the much-needed opportunity for survivors to pursue viable economic activities as well as assist in breast cancer treatment for members in need.

The Benue Breast Cancer Support Initiative relies on the support of committed donors to do our work. It is my sincere hope that the summary of our work in 2023 will show that your gifts are making a difference for the women of Benue State.

Stevina Evuleocha-Ugbah, Ph.D

BBCSI

WHO WE ARE

The Benue Breast Cancer Support Initiative (BBCSI) was founded in 2016 to provide a platform for breast cancer survivors and sympathizers/care givers-and victims to exchange resources, support members who are going through diagnosis and treatment, and to help educate Benue and global citizens about breast cancer. One of the goals of our group is to address the culture of secrecy surrounding cancer so our women and families stop hiding cancer diagnosis, get people educated about risk factors and lifestyle adjustments that can improve survivorship.

BBCSI has been organizing in person awareness campaigns every October in different local governments of Benue State since inception. The COVID pandemic caused us to move our campaign online for 2 years. To date, in addition to our annual awareness campaign, BBCSI has:

- Provided micro loans for members seeking to start small businesses.
- Granted long term loans to members for breast cancer treatment
- Matched funds for a member who needed radiation therapy.
- Provided emotional support and visitation to members undergoing treatment as well as those who have lost the fight against breast cancer.
- Collaborated with other groups with similar goals in Benue.
- Officially registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission.

We still have a long way to go to achieve one of our primary goals of providing grant support for women needing breast cancer therapies.

WHAT WE DO

Since 2016, BBCSI has been working to dismantle the culture of secrecy surrounding breast cancer in Benue State, Nigeria. Our nonprofit was registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission (CAC) of Nigeria in January, 2023. Every year going forward, we will produce an Annual Report and Financial Statement that showcases our accomplishments as well as our collaborations with other entities.

BBCSI presented and co-sponsored a few events geared towards educating the women of Benue State about breast cancer. As part of our 2023 campaign, we hosted an online discussion via Zoom. Participating in the discussion were a surgeon, an oncologist, and a radiologist. We also had a breast cancer survivor and a caregiver as panel participants to address the 2023 theme: Together We Can, Together Let's Fight Breast Cancer.

The Chairperson of BBCSI was invited to talk to women about checking themselves for breast cancer and sharing the message of dismantling the culture of secrecy by Amor Initiatives – a nonprofit which led a medical mission to Benue State in December 2023.

To foster the support, which was the foundation of our nonprofit, we make time to visit members who are undergoing treatment, have experienced the loss of a loved one or have succumbed to the fight against breast cancer. When a member passes away, we pay a condolence visit to the family.


BENUE BREAST CANCER SUPPORT INITIATIVE
BBCSI
WORLD BREAST CANCER
AWARENESS PANEL DISCUSSION
ORGANIZED BY
BENUE BREAST CANCER SURVIVORS SUPPORT INITIATIVE (BBCSI)
THEME
TOGETHER WE CAN,
TOGETHER LET'S FIGHT
BREAST CANCER
Chief Host
Prof (Emerita) Stevina Evuleocha-Ugbah
Guest Speaker
Dr Nchiewe Ani
Moderator
Prof Kohol Iornem
Panellist
Mrs. Ngomom Doo Gar
Panellist
Scholastica Mnena Lan
Guest Speaker
Dr Amos Uko. FWACS Consultant Gen.Surgeon
Guest Speaker
Hafsat Tukur Saulawa (FPCPharm)
October 28, 2023
18:00-20:00 (GMT+1) Time Zone in Nigeria
Online via Zoom, Meeting ID: 89188765728 Passcode: 357631



Members set to depart for the awareness campaign



The 2023 Campaign Banner



2023 Campaign at Ushongo LGA

BOARD OF TRUSTEES

Prof. Mrs. Stevina Evuleocha- Ugbah	Founder
Mrs. Hannah Mngohol Tion	Chairperson
Professor David Iornem	Member
Mrs. Linda Ade Ackaa	Member
Mrs. Judith Ngumimi. Ikpah	Member
Professor Andrea Avershima Ornguze	Member
Dr. Mrs. Amina Japheth Onyewuchi	Member
Dr Matthias Hile Iortyer	Member
Pharm. Mnena Schoalstica Lan	Secretary

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

Founder: Prof. (Emerita) Dr. Stevina Evuleocha-Ugbah + 1(925) 989-9697/pendaityo@gmail.com
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Chairperson: Mrs. Hannah Mngohol Tiohn (0703-301-1348/ mngoholtiohn@yahoo.com
Secretary: Mrs. Mnena Scholastica Lan FPSN (0803-308-3042/ mnenage@yahoo.com
Assistant Secretary: Mrs.Vera Ene Oko 08128777033
Treasurer: Mrs. Grace Erdoo Ateata (07037764676) / graceateata@gmail.com
Financial Secretary: Ms. Bibiana Seember Orpin 07064561131
Social Media Manager: Mrs. Florence Davies 07035982915

BBCSI

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The Benue Breast Cancer Support Initiative is a nonprofit organization registered with the Corporate Affairs Commission of Nigeria. BBCSI collaborates with like-minded nonprofits to lend a powerful voice to breast cancer awareness and to engage in advocacy for Benue women afflicted with breast cancer.

Breast cancer awareness is a movement that aims to increase awareness and reduce the stigma linked to the symptoms and treatment of breast cancer.

BBCSI